

Day 5 — Mapping to the Five Elements

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: connect each doṣa to its two constituent elements (vāta=ākāśa+vāyu, pitta=tejas+ap, kapha=ap+pr̥thvī).

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *prakṛti* (IAST: prakṛti; lit. “innate constitution”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Recall Module 2 *pañcabhūta*:** ākāśa (space), vāyu (air), tejas (fire), ap (water), pr̥thvī (earth).
2. **Map doṣas to element pairs.** Caraka’s framework:
 - vāta = ākāśa + vāyu (both light, mobile)
 - pitta = tejas + ap (transformation + medium)
 - kapha = ap + pr̥thvī (cohesion + heaviness)
3. **Why pairs, not single elements?** Each doṣa needs a quality AND a medium. Vāyu alone has no container; tejas alone burns without medium; pr̥thvī alone is inert. The pair makes the doṣa functional.
4. **Source.** Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, Sūtrasthāna 1.7 — the *tridoṣa* are the gross outcome of the *pañcamahābhūta*.
5. **Class exercise.** Pairs receive a list of 10 observations (“warm forehead,” “dry skin,” “feels heavy after lunch”). Classify each by likely doṣa AND the element pair that grounds the claim.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Mapping to the Five Elements.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).